



ECONOCARIBE

BEFORE THE www.econocaribe.com

FEDERAL MARITIME COMMISSION

DOCKET NO. 17-04

REGULATORY REFORM INITIATIVE

COMMENTS OF JOHN ABISCH

I am John Abisch, President of Econocaribe Consolidators Inc. Econocaribe operates in USA under the DBA of Ecu Worldwide with the OTI license 16318N. We have 9 offices in USA with 400 employees. We work with agents in some destinations and have over 300 Ecu Worldwide offices in 160 countries. The majority of our shipments utilize NRAs and we appreciate this option however our true desire is to eliminate the requirement of a tariff. Due to the hyper competitive market with over 4,000 licensed OTI's, the percentage of cargo which moves on a spot basis continues to increase. We have not had a single client request our publically accessible tariff during the past 3 years. There is a cost for us to meet this current requirement and it is clear the public is not interested in having this tool. Our recommendation for your consideration, is the elimination of tariff filing. If the elimination of tariff filing is not acceptable, we encourage you to consider revising the regulation on the NRA to accept that if a quote is made to the client and the client books the cargo using that quote, this should be considered acceptance of the NRA offer.

We are members of the NCBFAA and fully support the Association's efforts in the past to eliminate burdensome and unnecessary regulations of tariff filing. As the NCBFAA has pointed out in a number of prior comments, there is no public benefit to continue to require NVOCCs to publish rate tariffs, as they are not used by shippers for any purpose. We accordingly urge the FMC to exercise its authority to totally exempt NVOCCs from having to publish rate tariffs or at least to eliminate the restrictions on the use of NRAs.

DATED: June 23, 2017